

The Mozilla Location Service: Addressing Privacy Concerns

Dubbed a research project, Mozilla Location Service is the crowd-sourced mapping of wireless networks (Wi-Fi access points, cell phone towers, etc) around the world. This information is commonly used by mobile devices and computers to ascertain their location when GPS services are not available. The entry of Mozilla into this field is expected to be a game changer. So get to know more about Mozilla's MozStumbler mobile app as well as Ichnaea.



The Mozilla mission statement expresses a desire to promote openness, innovation and opportunity on the Web. And Mozilla is trying to comply with this pretty seriously.

Firefox, Thunderbird, Firefox OS... the list of Mozilla's open source products is growing. Yet there are several areas in which tech giants like Google, Nokia and Apple are dominant and the mobile ecosystem is one of them. Mozilla is now trying to break into this space. After Firefox OS, the foundation now offers a new service for mobile users.

There are several services that a user might not even be aware of while using a cell phone. The network-based location service is one of the most used services by cell phone owners to determine their location if the GPS service is not available. Several companies currently offer this service but there are major privacy concerns associated with it. It is no secret that advertising companies track a user's location history and offer ads or services based on it.

Till now, there was no transparent option among these services but Mozilla has come to our rescue, to prevent tech giants sniffing out our locations. As stated on